ADRIAN CIOANCA

PhD | Data & AI Consultant | Biotech Co-founder | **NV1 Security Clearance**

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PROFILE

Applying for the Associate role via the Advanced Professional Degree pathway. Most APD hires bring PhD-level rigour straight from the bench; this candidacy adds several years running the technical and commercial side of a biotech spin-off and live client delivery at Accenture — the consulting-readiness the APD pathway is designed to bet on, already tested against real clients rather than assumed from academic potential alone.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Accenture | Strategy & Consulting, Data & AI | Consultant / Team Lead — Jan 2026 – Present

- Took ownership of a Defence client's proof-of-concept data pipeline in a secure, air-gapped cloud environment, designing the technical approach end to end; demonstrated that the team could deliver production-grade data products under air-gapped constraints.
- Led a 3-person data engineering team to diagnose a national energy retailer's regulatory compliance bottleneck, then architected an automated analytics solution that assessed business activities against regulatory requirements; applied research-informed NLP and retrieval techniques to cut clause identification from days to minutes.
- Built an internal Defence market-intelligence platform using React, FastAPI and AI agents over AusTender, ministerial releases and competitor activity; reduced opportunity research from hours to minutes and now feeds market sizing for live bids.

ErythroSIGHT | Co-founder & CTO — 2023 – Present

- Co-founded an ANU spin-off with 3 researchers to commercialise blood-derived retinal therapeutics; set scientific strategy, selected the lead candidate and coordinated contract research organisations, IP and regulatory partners through pre-clinical (IND-enabling) planning, securing 3 national patents and commercialising the technology through licensing.
- Built the valuation and market case for a preclinical asset using discounted-cash-flow and risk-adjusted NPV models, prevalence and pricing; co-developed investor materials and pitched at 3 national accelerators, raising **$670K** in non-dilutive funding and winning CSIRO ON Accelerate (<5% acceptance).
- Established and led ErythroSIGHT's consulting arm, securing a **$300K** engagement with Beta Therapeutics and delivering a **$200K** end-to-end preclinical model for Merck & Co.; reduced time to results from 3 months to 2 weeks, moved the work in-house, and returned **8x** the build cost.

Australian National University | Postdoctoral Researcher, John Curtin School of Medical Research — 2022 – 2026

- Led a 7-person team across 20 research groups at 7 universities developing RNA therapeutics for retinal degeneration; reached 25 papers (9 lead-author), ranked 3rd nationally in the field, and secured **$514K** in competitive funding.
- Earned promotion to Level B in 1.5 years versus a typical 4–5 year progression, demonstrating sustained performance in research leadership and delivery.
- Designed analytics pipelines for biotech partners, identifying a new indication for VivaZome's lead therapeutic and supporting a **$3M** government co-funded (CRC-P) raise; work for MDImune secured joint IP in South Korea and increased lead-product efficacy 20%.

EDUCATION

Australian National University | PhD, Neuroscience & Bioinformatics — 2018 – 2022

- **Frank Fenner Medal** for best PhD at the John Curtin School of Medical Research (1 of 103); J.G. Crawford Prize nominee for best thesis at ANU.
- Australian Postgraduate Award ($112K, top 5%); 4 competitive research grants ($97K; 5–10% success rates); elected ANU representative to the Global Young Scientists Summit.

University of New South Wales | BSc Advanced Science, First Class Honours — 2013 – 2017

- Top honours thesis mark; 2 research scholarships awarded to the top 10% of the faculty.

LEADERSHIP & ADDITIONAL

- **Teaching & leadership:** Sole genetics lecturer, ANU Medical School (4.8/5 average across 87 evaluations); founded Vision ACTion, connecting clinicians, researchers and patients.
- Led 5-person team to 2nd of 10 at InnovFest Singapore, pitching to Westpac and Singtel; recognised for delivery/community contribution by 3 Accenture Managing Directors.
- Chess team captain; 4th, NSW Mathematics Olympiad.

CAPABILITIES

Analytical: Statistical modelling, machine learning, Python, R, SQL | **Commercial:** Financial modelling, valuation, market sizing, competitor analysis, IP strategy